

0.5 Research Design & Ethics.

How do Psychologists design research?

Non-Experimental 1

Purpose: to observe & record behaviour

How Conducted: Case Studies, Naturalistic Observation, Surveys

Nothing is Manipulated

Weakness: No control of variables
Single cases may mislead

Non-Experimental 2

Purpose: detect naturally occurring relationships
assess how well a predicts b

How Conducted: Collect data on 2+ vars
no manipulation

Nothing is manipulated

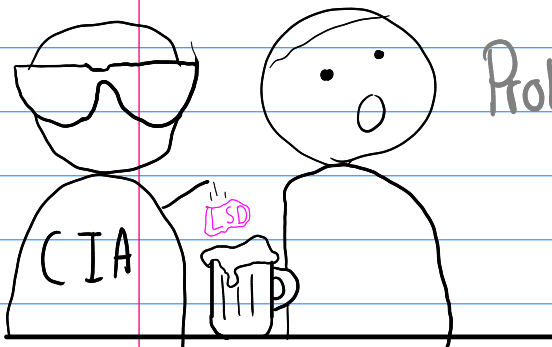
Weakness: Cannot specify cause & effect 1

Experimental

Purpose: to explore cause & effect

How conducted: manipulate 1+ factors
use random assignment

Independent variable is Manipulated



Problems: Sometimes not feasible
results may not generalize
some vars aren't ethical to manipulate

An example of an unethical experiment ↑
refers to MK-ultra, an
experiment done by
american terrorists
who drugged non-consenting
individuals to study
"mind-control"

In Psych research we can't answer
questions that are:

- unethical
- untestable

However we can measure how individual's
beliefs in these questions affect how
people think & behave

Personal Connection

There are many questions
I have about the world that
are untestable, and some
more that we may never
know the testability of,

Once a question is chosen psychologists
select the best design for the question

They then decide whether to use
qualitative or quantitative research.

Regardless of method, researchers want to be able to have confidence in their findings, so they consider the effects of **compounding variables** and their own subconscious biases

How do laboratory conditions relate to real life?

The experimenter intends for the laboratory to be a **simplified reality**

The purpose of an experiment is not to exactly recreate real life but rather to test **theoretical principles**

Ex. pushing a button that delivers a noise blast isn't the same as a punch, but **the principle is the same**

How do Psychologists study animals?

Since humans are biologically very similar to many animals, we can glean a lot from studying them.

Animals are a **simplified** way to learn about all the complexities of the human body

"We cannot defend our scientific work on the basis of the [similarities] and then defend it morally on the basis of differences-

- Roger Ulrich

Is it right to place human well-being over that of other animals?

If so, what safeguards should protect animal well-being in research?

APA guidelines state that researchers must provide "humane care and healthful conditions" and that testing should "minimize discomfort"

Protecting People

Many early studies put their human participants in very unethical conditions

Now

- researchers must obtain informed consent
- protect participants from greater-than-usual harm
- keep information about individual participants confidential
- fully debrief people

Ensuring Scientific Integrity

Mistakes happen, but intentionally distributing false results and is **fraud**.

One major piece of misinformation was an article published in 1998 falsely correlating vaccines with autism. The consequences of this still affect us to this day, as this study led many to murder other people through their refusal to vaccinate.

MCA:

1. c

2. c

3. b

4. d

5. d